

Accounts guide

You handle **invoices**, **payments**, **recurring billing**, and the **receivables / revenue** reports.

Your dashboard

- **Outstanding receivables** — total still owed to NEDS. Always matches the **Receivables report** total exactly (same underlying figure) — an invoice whose client record has since been removed still counts here and shows as "Client removed" on the Receivables report, rather than silently disappearing from either number.
- **Collected this month** — payments received. Click ****View payments collected**** below the number for the individual payments behind it (date, client, invoice, mode, who recorded it).
- **Overdue invoices** — count past their due date. Click ****View overdue invoices**** below the number to see exactly which ones.
- **Overdue tasks alert** — if you have any tasks past their due date, a red banner appears at the top of the dashboard with a direct link to your task list.
- **Unapplied client advances** — total money received that hasn't been applied to an invoice yet. Click **View advances** to see every client with money on file. See "Client Advances" below.
- **Your Productivity This Month** — your rank among other Accounts staff this month, an overall score, and your biggest opportunity area. Private to you — nobody else sees your rank, and you don't see anyone else's. If AI is enabled, click **Get tips to improve** for a specific suggestion based on your own numbers — if you have a monthly target set (below), the tip is built around exactly how much you need to close the gap, not just a general nudge.
- **Your target this month** — a progress bar against your monthly **collections recorded** target (the total value of payments you've recorded), if Admin/Manager has set one for you (Team Targets page). "No target set" is normal if they haven't.

Resources

Sidebar → **Resources** has two tabs — **Files** and **Links**. You can view whatever your role can see on both; adding, editing, or removing entries is Admin/Manager only. **Files** is worth checking before you dig through old email or ask around — the GST certificate, for example, lives here under **Certificates & Compliance**, alongside other things like plugin builds,

templates, and SOPs. Some files are restricted to specific roles ("Visible to") — if you can't find something you expect, it may not be tagged for Accounts yet; ask Admin/Manager to add it or open it up.

Every **client's own page** also has its own **Links** tab, separate from this page — that client's website, Google Business Profile, socials, Drive folder, payment links, and similar. Anyone who can open the client's page can see these.

Your ideal day-to-day rhythm

Daily

- Check your bell notifications first — 💰 payments recorded by others, 🏠 advances recorded with no invoice yet, 🚩 broken payment promises, ⚠️ invoices due in 7 days.
- Work down the **Collections** report — it's built specifically as "who to chase today," combining overdue days, payment-promise status, and milestone-ready-to-invoice flags in one place.
- Record any payments received that day against the right invoice, same day — the dashboard and receivables reports only stay trustworthy if this doesn't lag.
- Assign invoice numbers on anything showing the yellow "Pending Invoice #" badge before it's sent.

Weekly

- Review **Recurring Invoices** — confirm the auto-generated cycle actually fired for active retainers, and check anything flagged Not Billed or Ended that shouldn't be.
- Check the **Contract & Renewal Dashboard** for anything expiring in the next 30/60/90 days.
- Log the week's **Expenses** if it's been piling up rather than entered daily.

Monthly

- Pull the **Revenue Report** and **Business Overview** for month-end close — income by service/client, recurring vs one-time split, AR aging.
- Reconcile: does "Collected this month" on the dashboard match what actually landed in the bank? Chase any gap immediately, not at year-end.

As things happen

- Money arrives before there's a quotation or invoice → see ****Client Advances**** below.
- Client deducted TDS → enter it in the payment's TDS field, don't just record the lower cash amount.
- Payment detail typo'd → use **Edit** on that payment (date/mode/reference only — amount/TDS still need delete-and-re-record, since those drive the invoice balance).

- GST charged wrongly → fixable via Edit only *before* any payment exists; after that, it needs a credit note.

1. Invoices

Invoices lists every invoice. Invoices are **GST-compliant**:

- **Maharashtra clients** → tax splits into **CGST + SGST**.
- **Other states (India)** → **IGST** at the full rate.
- **Overseas clients** → **zero-rated** (export of services, no GST). The PDF

is labelled "INVOICE" with an "Export of Services / Zero-Rated Supply" note instead of the usual tax rows. This is set automatically when the client's

Country is anything other than "India" — no manual adjustment needed.

- Each invoice has a number like **NEDS/2026-27/0042** (the financial year runs April–March), shows both parties' GSTINs, HSN/SAC per line, the tax breakup, and the **amount in words**.

Creating an invoice: usually a salesperson converts an accepted **quotation** into an invoice; it then appears here ready for your review. When first created the invoice shows a yellow **"Pending Invoice #"** badge — it has no GST number yet. Open it and click **Assign Invoice Number** to generate the next sequential NEDS invoice number (e.g. [NEDS/2026-27/0042](#)). You must assign a number before you can send or download the invoice PDF.

Milestone/project billing: a single deal can be billed in parts (e.g. advance on signing, balance on delivery) — each milestone becomes its own invoice. These also start with a pending number; assign it when you're ready to issue the invoice.

A Draft invoice can also arrive automatically — SMDost creates a ₹0 placeholder invoice the moment a content brief is approved, for you to price and send. You'll get a notification the moment it lands; if it's still sitting as Draft 3 days later, the "what to do next" popup (bottom-right corner of every page) will also prompt you to price and send it — same idea as the Sales "call this lead now" popup, just for Accounts. Similarly, a quotation marked **Accepted** with no invoice raised after 3 days triggers the same popup, prompting you to open it and **Convert to invoice**. Both clear themselves automatically the moment you act — Admin/Manager see the same prompts, in case Accounts hasn't gotten to it yet.

****A milestone invoice can also appear on its own, with a payment already recorded, without anyone on the team creating it.**** The public quotation link sent to the client has a "Pay ₹X now" button for whichever milestone is next due — if they pay it online, the CRM raises that milestone's invoice and records the payment automatically (mode **Gateway**, reference starting [Razorpay ...](#), same as any other online invoice payment). You'll still see it in the normal places (Invoices list, the quotation's Milestone Manager, the Collections report) — just assign it a NEDS invoice number like any other

invoice when you notice it. Nothing to do differently.

***"Log Invoice" (top of the Invoices list) is for recording an invoice already issued outside the CRM** — historically in Hitech, the older billing tool — so it shows up here for record-keeping, alongside real client history. **Always type that invoice's actual Hitech number in the "Hitech Invoice Number" field (e.g. `HT-2026-0042`), never a `NEDS/ ...`-style number.** NEDS-format numbers are reserved for the CRM's own auto-generated sequence — typing one in here manually, especially alongside a back-dated invoice date, can collide with a number the system later tries to hand out automatically. If you're recording several old invoices at once, the **CSV import** on the same screen is safer than typing them in one at a time.

Milestone work status: each milestone on the quotation now has a status — **Pending / In Progress / Done** — separate from whether it's been invoiced. Whoever is running the project marks a milestone **Done** once that phase of work is actually finished (e.g. "UAT complete"). Once Done and not yet invoiced, it shows a green **Ready to invoice** badge on the quotation's Milestone Manager and on the **Collections** report (below) — that's your signal to raise the next invoice. This is still set manually by the team — nothing flips it automatically.

Milestone Done suggestion: if the project's tasks (Emptask) are tagged to a milestone via the task's **Milestone** field, the Milestone Manager shows a one-click "All N linked tasks done — mark this milestone Done?" nudge once every linked task is completed. It's only a suggestion — someone still has to click it, so a milestone never flips to Done on its own just because tasks finished.

Non-GST clients: some clients need a plain bill with no GST charged. Open the client and tick **Non-GST client** — new quotations and invoices for them default to no GST (PDF shows "INVOICE" instead of "TAX INVOICE", no CGST/SGST/IGST rows). You can still override it per document with the same checkbox on the Quotation/Invoice builder if a one-off exception is needed. To fix an invoice that was wrongly issued as GST, open it in **Edit** and untick the GST box — this only works before any payment has been recorded; once a payment exists the invoice is locked and needs a credit note instead.

Deleting an invoice: if an invoice was created by mistake or is otherwise wrong, open it and click **Delete** (Admin, Manager, and Accounts can all do this). This works even if a payment has already been recorded against it — deleting removes the invoice and any of its payments together, so use it deliberately, not as a routine correction (for a GST mistake on an already-paid invoice, a credit note is usually the right tool instead — see above). Deleted invoices and payments are kept internally in case they ever need to be recovered, but they no longer show up anywhere in the CRM.

1a. Client Advances — money received before a quotation or invoice exists

Sometimes an advance lands in the bank before a client is even entered as a Lead, or before Sales has raised a quotation for an existing client. A payment can only ever be recorded against an invoice, so there's nothing to attach it to yet — this is what Client Advances is for.

Recording an advance: if the client doesn't exist in the CRM at all yet, create them directly under **Clients** → **New Client** — skip Lead entirely, since money has already arrived, this is already a real relationship, not a prospect. Then open the client's page, go to the **Invoices** tab, and use **+ Record Advance** (amount, date, mode, an optional reference/note). This does **not** create any GST document — it's an internal record of cash received, held until it's applied to a real invoice.

Applying an advance: once a real invoice exists for that client (Sales raises the quotation, you convert it, or you log/create the invoice as usual), open the invoice — if the client has money on file, an ****Apply advance**** section appears above Record Payment. Enter how much of the advance to apply (defaults to the full amount, capped automatically at whichever is smaller: what's left of the advance or the invoice's balance) and click **Apply**. This creates a real payment against the invoice — it shows in the payment list with a **(via advance)** note, and everything downstream (the invoice balance, Collections, Receivables, "Collected this month," the payment-recorded notification) updates exactly as if fresh cash had been recorded that day.

Partial use: an advance can be applied across more than one invoice, or partially now and the rest later — its own status tracks this (**Outstanding** → **Partially Applied** → **Fully Applied**) alongside how much remains.

Cancelling an advance: if the money needs to be written off or refunded before it's ever applied, open the client's Invoices tab and click **Cancel** next to that advance. Only available while nothing has been applied from it yet — once even part of it has settled a real invoice, that's now a real payment on record and needs a normal correction instead (see "Correcting a mistaken payment" below).

Where to see everything outstanding: the dashboard's ****Unapplied client advances**** tile links to a list of every client with money on file across the whole company.

2. Recording payments

Open an invoice → **record a payment** (amount, date, mode — UPI / NEFT / cheque / cash / gateway). **Partial payments are allowed:** the invoice moves to

Partially paid, then ***Paid*** once fully settled. Status updates automatically.

TDS (Tax Deducted at Source): if the client deducted TDS before paying, enter it in the optional **TDS Amount** field alongside the payment amount. The invoice's TDS total and balance update automatically — an invoice counts as fully settled once **amount paid + TDS deducted** reaches the total, even though the actual cash received is less. The invoice page shows a TDS tile next to Total/Paid/Balance, and the PDF adds a "TDS deducted" / "Net payable" line once any TDS has been recorded on that invoice.

Sending a payment receipt: when any of the client's contacts has an email address on file, a **Send payment receipt to client** checkbox appears at the bottom of the Record Payment form. Tick it before clicking Record — the client receives an email confirming the amount received, payment mode, reference number, and the remaining balance (or a "fully settled" message if the invoice is now paid in full).

Bell notification — payment recorded: when a payment is saved, a 💰 bell notification is sent to all accounts staff (except the person who recorded it) and to the client's assigned sales person. No action needed — it's purely informational so everyone stays aware of cash coming in.

Bell notification — new client onboarded: the very first time a payment of any kind lands against a client (a manually recorded payment, an advance applied, or an online Razorpay payment), a separate  notification goes to Admin and Manager — not on every payment, only that first one. It names the client, lists their currently active services, and the amount paid, and links straight to the client's profile.

Correcting a mistaken payment date, mode, or reference: click **Edit** next to any payment already listed on the invoice page to fix a typo without deleting and re-recording it — an inline form lets you change the **date**, **mode**, and **reference number**. The ****amount and TDS are not editable here**** — if either of those was entered wrong, you still need to delete the payment and record it again, since those two drive the invoice's balance and status and may have already triggered a payment-received email to the client. Every correction is logged to the activity trail for an audit record.

Payment follow-up tracking: when a client says "I'll pay in a day or two" past the due date, open the invoice and set **Client promised to pay by** to that date, so it's not just in your head. If that date passes and the invoice is still unpaid, it's flagged **Payment promise broken** (red badge on the invoice, and on the **Collections** report below) — a clear signal to call again. Use the notes box on the same page to log what was actually said each time you follow up.

Bell notification — payment promise broken: you no longer have to remember to check. The morning after a promised date passes with the invoice still unpaid, a 🚩 bell notification goes out to accounts staff, admin, and

managers. It fires once per promise — if the client gives you a new date and that one breaks too, you'll get a fresh notification for it.

3. Recurring invoices

For monthly retainers (SEO, GMB, social, ads, AMC), set up a ****recurring invoice template (under Invoices → Recurring Invoices). The system** auto-generates the invoice each cycle** (every morning the scheduler checks for due templates) and emails it to the client automatically. You can pause/resume a template anytime.

Created from a quotation: if Sales ticked line items **Recurring** on a quotation and used **Create recurring invoice** from it, the resulting template carries a link back to that quotation — visible on both the template's page and the quotation's own page — so you can always trace a monthly charge back to what was originally quoted and agreed.

"Ended" vs. "On Hold" / "Paused" (Invoices → Recurring Invoices list): this describes the **template's own schedule**, not whether its invoice got paid.

Ended means the template had an end date, that date has passed, and it won't bill again — nothing to do, it ran its course. **On Hold / Paused** means someone clicked Pause, or the template simply has no end date set yet still isn't active — check whether it should be resumed. Ended templates are hidden from this list by default (they'd otherwise pile up forever) — click **Show ended templates** to see them again. If you set up one template per one-month period, expect it to flip to Ended right after its single invoice generates; if you want an ongoing retainer to keep billing every month automatically, leave **End date** blank instead of re-creating a new template each month.

****One recurring template per billing month is the normal way to do month-by-month invoicing and payment tracking**** — for either a current client's ongoing monthly retainer or an older client's still-pending historical months. A template auto-pausing right after generating its one invoice is expected, not an error. It's fine and safe to click **Activate** on it again afterward — e.g. to regenerate a corrected invoice for that same month (delete the wrong one first, then Activate + ****Generate & Send Now****), or simply to keep it available while that month's payment is still outstanding. Reactivating never risks a surprise duplicate: the unattended daily scheduler only ever auto-generates from a template whose next run is still within its own end date, so a reactivated one-cycle template just sits there until **you** generate from it again on purpose.

****Status on the client's Services tab is different — it tracks the period, not the schedule: the same recurring template shows one of Upcoming**** (hasn't started yet), **Active** (today falls within its period and it's

still on), **On Hold** (today falls within its period but it's paused),

Payment Received / Payment Pending (the period is over — based on whether its generated invoice is actually paid), or **Not Billed** (the period is over and no invoice was ever generated for it — e.g. a template that was paused before its first billing cycle, kept around for historical record). The Payment Received/Pending detail only shows to roles with invoice access (e.g. not Support) — everyone else sees **Ended** for a finished period regardless of its payment status (this "Ended" wording is specific to that restricted view — Admin/Manager and anyone else with invoice access never see it; they see Not Billed instead when nothing was ever generated). One template deliberately never shows here at all: if its only invoice was generated and then deleted, and it was never reactivated, it's treated as abandoned and hidden from the client's view entirely rather than showing a misleading On Hold/Not Billed row for something that was retracted.

Non-GST clients: when you pick a client marked **Non-GST client** on their profile, the template's **Non-GST client** checkbox is ticked automatically — every invoice generated from that template (auto or via Generate & Send Now) skips GST. You can still tick or untick it yourself for a one-off exception; once saved, the template keeps whatever you set even if the client's own Non-GST setting changes later, so update the template directly if that ever needs to change. When Non-GST is checked, each line item's GST% field is grayed out with a note — it's ignored, the invoice will show ₹0 tax regardless of what's in that field. The **Est. / cycle** figure on the client's Services tab reflects this too — it only shows the "+GST" hint when the template will actually charge GST.

Deleting a recurring template: if a retainer has ended, open the template and click **Delete** (or use the Delete button on the Recurring Invoices list). This removes the template and its schedule; **previously generated invoices are kept**.

Pause is not the same as Delete — Pause just stops future billing but keeps the template (it'll show as On Hold); if you're cleaning up a duplicate or test template you created by mistake, make sure you click **Delete**, not Pause, or it'll still be there.

Filtering by billing month: at the top of the **Recurring Invoices** list, pick a month to filter templates down to the ones actually billed that month — each row then shows that period's invoice number, status, and amount inline, so you can quickly answer "what did we bill in August" in one place instead of opening each template's own history.

Project field (optional): when creating or editing a template, you can link it to one of the client's own Projects. This matters most for a **reseller-billed** client (see Manager guide → Reseller billing) — since

those templates are GST-billed to the reseller's own customer record, not the client you actually picked, setting the Project is the only way that client's own Project page, and their own Client page's Invoices/Services tabs, can still show "yes, this is billed and active" (tagged ****Billed via {reseller}****) instead of looking like nothing was ever set up for them. For a normal (non-reseller) client the Project field is optional and purely for cross-reference — invoicing already works correctly without it.

Viewing generated invoices: click **Invoices** on any recurring template row to open its history — every invoice that has been auto-generated for that template, with status, balance, and action buttons.

Resending an invoice by email: on the recurring template's invoice history page, click **Send Email** on the row you want to resend. The same **InvoiceIssued** email goes to the client's billing contact.

Recording a payment: click **View / Pay** on any generated invoice row to open the full invoice page, then use the **Record payment** form at the bottom. Partial payments are supported.

Advance reminders to the client: the system automatically emails the client **7, 5, 3, and 1 day before** each upcoming billing date so they're never surprised. No action needed from you — the scheduler sends these at 09:00 IST daily.

Bell notification — invoice due in 7 days: every morning at **8 AM**, if any recurring-linked invoice has a due date exactly 7 days away and hasn't been paid yet, a  bell notification is sent to all accounts staff, admin, and managers. This gives you a full week to follow up before the invoice becomes overdue.

Bell notification — contract renewal due soon: every morning at **8:30 AM**, if an active recurring template's **end date** falls within the next 30 days, you (and admin/manager, plus that client's sales rep) get a  bell notification — a nudge to renew the contract or follow up before it lapses. Fires once per end date; if the contract is renewed to a later date, you'll be notified again once that new date comes within 30 days.

Contract & Renewal Dashboard (sidebar → **Contract & Renewals**, shared with Manager and Sales) — the fuller view behind that bell notification: every active contract ending in the next **30, 60, or 90 days**, each with a **renewal status** (Not Started → Discussion → Proposal Sent → Negotiation → Renewed/Lost) you or Sales can set, plus an **MRR at stake** total for whichever window you're looking at.

3a. Expenses

Expenses in the sidebar tracks daily office spend — tea/refreshments, travel, stationery, internet, fuel, rent, utilities, or other. No approval step: **Expenses** → **New Expense**, pick a category, enter the amount and a short description, set the date, and save. The list can be filtered by

month and/or category, with a **Total** tile that reflects whatever's currently filtered — leave both blank to see the running total for everything.

4. Reports

- **Account** (in the sidebar) → the **outstanding receivables** report: who owes what, and how overdue.
- **Collections** (in the sidebar) → the client-by-client follow-up worklist.
- **Cash Forecast** (linked from Business Overview) → recurring revenue expected + receivables due, bucketed by the next 3 months, plus the open pipeline's weighted forecast shown separately (it's indicative, not committed cash — deals don't have an expected-close date to bucket by month). For each client with something outstanding: how much is ****recurring not paid (a retainer client hasn't paid at all)**, other unpaid** (a one-time/milestone invoice with zero payment), and **partial — pending** (some paid, some still owed), plus the oldest overdue days (with an approximate month count alongside it), any payment-promise date (red if broken), and — for milestone-billed projects — the completion % and whether the next milestone is **Ready to invoice**. Use the picker at the top to view **All clients**, **Direct clients** (no referring partner), or one specific partner's clients only. This is the page to work down each morning if you're chasing payments.
- From the **Dashboard** → **Reports** panel → **Revenue Report**: income by month, by service, and by client, split into **recurring vs one-time**. Export to CSV.
- From the same panel → **Business Overview**: the executive snapshot. As Accounts you get the full financial detail (same as Admin) — AR aging broken into current/0-30/31-60/61-90/90+ day buckets with the itemized overdue invoice list, the full MRR breakdown by service plus which recurring contracts expire in the next 30 days, and the named top-5/top-10 client breakdown behind the concentration percentages. Also shows partner referral performance (as plain text, not a link — a partner's own page with their billing/collections detail is Admin/Manager only) and the company-wide pipeline/win-rate funnel. Export to CSV.

5. Invoice emails

Invoice emails sent to clients now have a **professional branded layout**: NEDS header, invoice summary card (number, amount, dates), amount in words, and — when bank details are configured — a **Payment Details** panel with account number, IFSC code, and UPI ID. The same details appear on the PDF, and whenever a UPI ID is set AND the invoice still has a balance due, the PDF also shows a ****Scan to Pay QR code**** pre-filled with the exact amount owed — the client's UPI app

opens straight to the payment screen, nothing to type in. It disappears on its own once the invoice is fully paid. Bank/UPI details are set in the server

`.env` (`COMPANY_BANK_NAME` , `COMPANY_ACCOUNT_NUMBER` , `COMPANY_UPI_ID` , etc.)

— ask your developer to update them.

Tips

- **Assign the invoice number before sending** — the Send button is disabled until a number has been assigned.
- Record payments promptly so receivables and the dashboard stay accurate.
- Overdue invoices are flagged automatically each morning, and payment reminders go out to clients.
- Daily digest and reminder emails are **not sent on Sundays**.
- If you delete a recurring invoice template, the previously generated invoices are kept for financial records — only the template and its schedule are removed.